

HEAD OF PRODUCT

Take-home exercise

Getting merchants live on the AI Agent

The scenario below is fictional — the funnel figures and merchant quotes are invented — but it's representative of the problems this role deals with week to week. There's no answer key: we're interested in how you frame the problem, what you'd do first, and how you'd know whether it worked. If we take it forward, you'll walk us through it live, so there's no need to over-produce it.

01 · THE PROBLEM

Merchants sign up, then take three weeks to switch the agent on

In this scenario, a merchant who signs up to Zaapi takes a median of 19 days to get an AI Agent live on a single channel. Around 39% never get one live at all.

It's the company's biggest commercial problem. Merchants who get the agent live and keep it live renew at a considerably higher rate than those who don't, and the ones who stall rarely come back to it on their own initiative. Every week an agent sits un-activated is a week the merchant is paying for a platform they're only half using — which is a renewal conversation that's already lost.

We want your read on why it's happening, and what you'd do about it.

02 · HOW SETUP WORKS TODAY

Six steps, all self-serve

This is the sequence a merchant works through inside the product to get an AI Agent running. Support is available throughout, and enterprise accounts get hands-on help from our commercial team. SMB merchants are largely on their own.

1 Connect a channel

Link at least one of WhatsApp, LINE, Facebook, Instagram, Shopee, Lazada, TikTok Shop or Shopify. Most merchants have already done this in order to use our Helpdesk.

2 Add the agent's knowledge

Supply the information the agent answers from — products, shipping, returns, store policies, common questions. Merchants can paste text, upload files, or point us at a URL to crawl.

3 Set the persona

Name the agent and decide how it should sound — language, tone, how formal it is, and the things it must never say.

4 Write the scenarios

Set out the situations the merchant expects — an order-status question, a refund request, a sizing question, an angry customer — and what the agent should do in each, including when to hand the conversation to a human.

5 Test it

A test mode where the merchant can hold a conversation with the agent before any customer is able to reach it.

6 Go live

Turn the agent on for a chosen channel, and set what share of incoming conversations it handles.

Go through it yourself. Sign up free at app.zaapi.com and build an agent — knowledge, persona, scenarios, then test it. Half an hour in the product will tell you far more than this description does, and we'd rather you formed your own view of where the friction is than took ours.

03 · THE FUNNEL

Where the hundred merchants go

Of every 100 merchants who sign up to Zaapi and start setting up an AI Agent:

STEP	REACHED	NOTES
Connected at least one channel	94	Mostly already done via Helpdesk
Added any knowledge	79	
Set a persona	71	
Wrote at least one scenario	38	Strongly correlated with staying live
Ran at least one test conversation	66	
Set the agent live on any channel	61	Median 19 days after signup
Still live 30 days later	52	Of the 9 who switched off, most within 72h

Median time from signup to the first setup step of any kind: 4 days.

Two other things worth knowing

- Merchants who go live on WhatsApp, LINE, Facebook or Instagram get there faster than those who go live on Shopee, Lazada or TikTok Shop.
- Activation rate is materially worse for accounts that signed up during a marketplace campaign period (Double 11, 12.12, Ramadan sale).

04 · WHAT MERCHANTS TELL US

Six accounts that stalled

Six merchants who signed up and never got an agent live, as reported back by the commercial team.

I added our FAQ document but I don't know if that's enough. How do I know it's ready? I don't want to find out from a customer.

Beauty brand · ~3,000 orders/mo · Bangkok

I wasn't sure what I was supposed to write. It asked for our policies, but our policies are just things we know. Nobody has written them down.

Fashion seller · ~800 orders/mo · Manila

We turned it on Friday. On Saturday it told a customer the wrong thing about our shipping to East Malaysia, my team panicked, so we turned it off. Maybe we try again later.

Home goods · ~5,000 orders/mo · Kuala Lumpur

I set it up in English because that's what the form was in. But 90% of our customers write in Thai. I'm not sure whether that matters.

Supplements seller · ~1,200 orders/mo · Chiang Mai

Honestly I signed up and then it was Double 11 and I had no time. It's been sitting there since November.

Electronics accessories · ~9,000 orders/mo · Jakarta

I skipped the scenarios part — I thought the knowledge would be enough. It answers questions fine, but the moment someone asks to cancel an order it just says it'll pass them to the team. Which is us.

Fashion seller · ~2,500 orders/mo · Ho Chi Minh City

05 · KEY DELIVERABLES

Key deliverables

1 A memo — two pages maximum

Any format you like. Cover these four things:

- **What's actually going wrong.** Your read on the root causes, rather than a restatement of the funnel.
- **What you'd change.** Be concrete — specific changes rather than directions of travel.
- **What you'd do first.** And why in that order — including anything you'd deliberately choose not to do.
- **How you'd know it worked.** What you'd measure, and what result would tell you that you were wrong.

2 A rough prototype — one or two screens

Show us the main change you'd make. Boxes and labels are completely fine — Figma, slides, a photo of a whiteboard, whatever is fastest for you. We are not assessing visual craft, and you don't need to be a designer: we want to see how you'd shape the thing you argued for in the memo, because a screen usually exposes decisions that prose lets you avoid.

3 The prompts you used

If you used AI to help with any of this — and we'd expect you to — share the prompts. Directing these tools well is a real part of this job, and we're far more interested in seeing how you do it than in you leaving it out.

06 · PRACTICALITIES

Before you start

- ☐ **Get into the product.** Sign up at app.zaapi.com and create an agent.
- ☐ **Questions.** Email us and we'll answer as soon as we can.
- ☐ **Returning it.** Send everything to rob@zaapi.com. If it's something we want to take forward, we'll invite you in to discuss it in an interview.

Zaapi · Head of Product · Bangkok (hybrid, Thonglor)

Questions about this exercise or the role: reply to the covering email.

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